

Franklin's



KEY INSIGHT_

“The warmth was real. It just wasn't reaching people before they arrived.”

PROBLEM_

The warmth was real — it just wasn't reaching people before they arrived.

Close the gap between what first-time visitors expected digitally and what they actually found when they walked in.

MY ROLE_

Team lead on a five-person UXDG 101 project — from fieldwork to final prototype.

SOLUTION_

The redesign didn't change Franklin's identity — it made it clearer upfront.

Most friction started before anyone walked through the door.

The homepage was restructured to surface practical expectations earlier – seating, service style, hours. Navigation reduced to four items; the order flow redesigned as a clear sequence with explicit progress cues.

RESEARCH_

Contextual inquiry at the café.

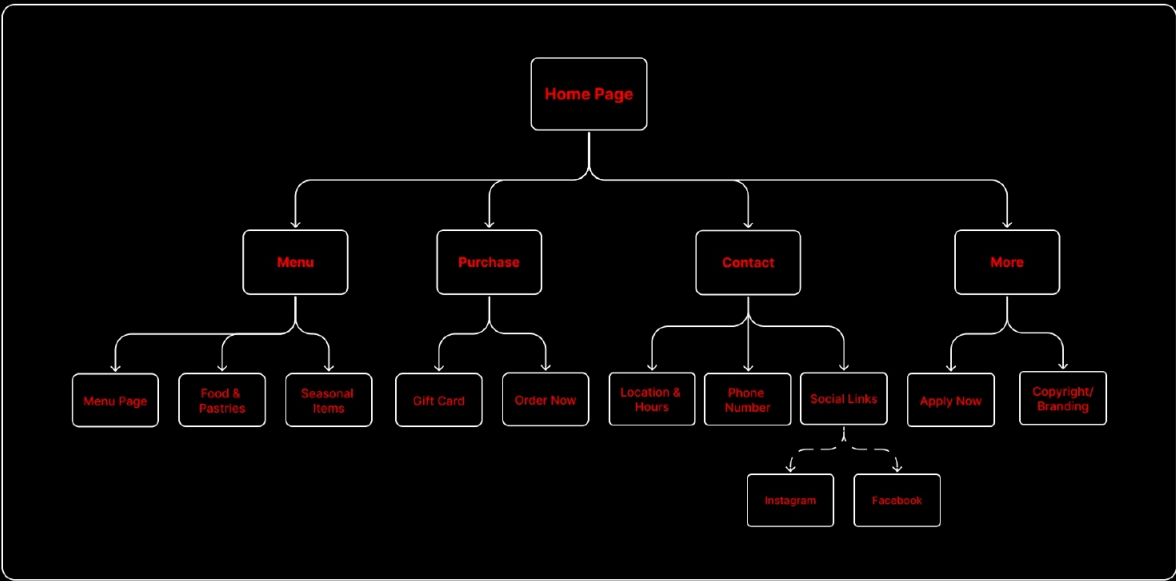
Barista and customer interviews, plus a SCAD student survey. The website was outdated, the service model unclear, and the in-store warmth had no digital equivalent.

CHALLENGE_

Users don't think in business categories — they think in tasks.

Card sorting on FigJam revealed four natural buckets: Menu, Order, About, Contact. That structure became the backbone of the redesigned IA.

Hypothesis IA



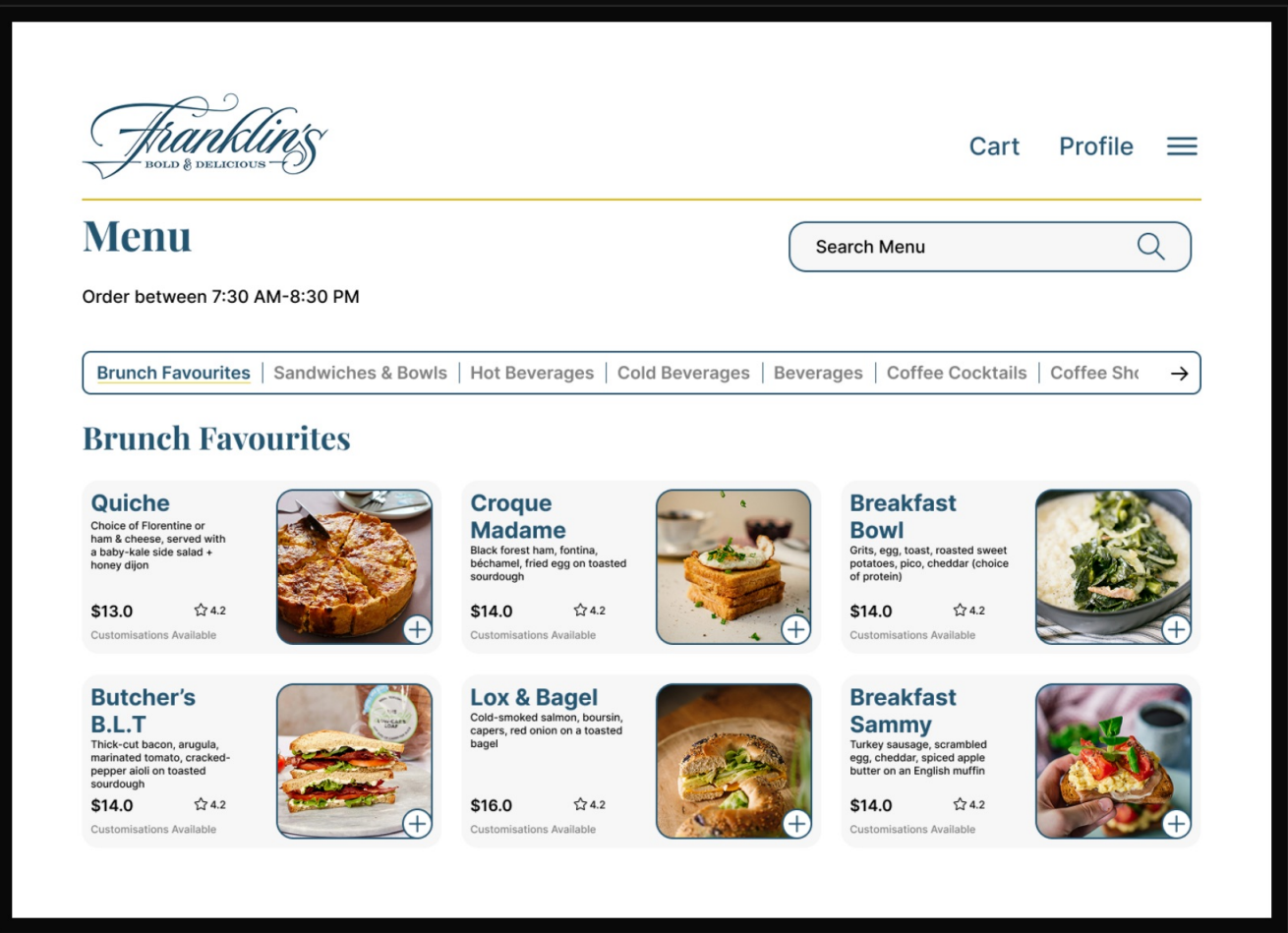
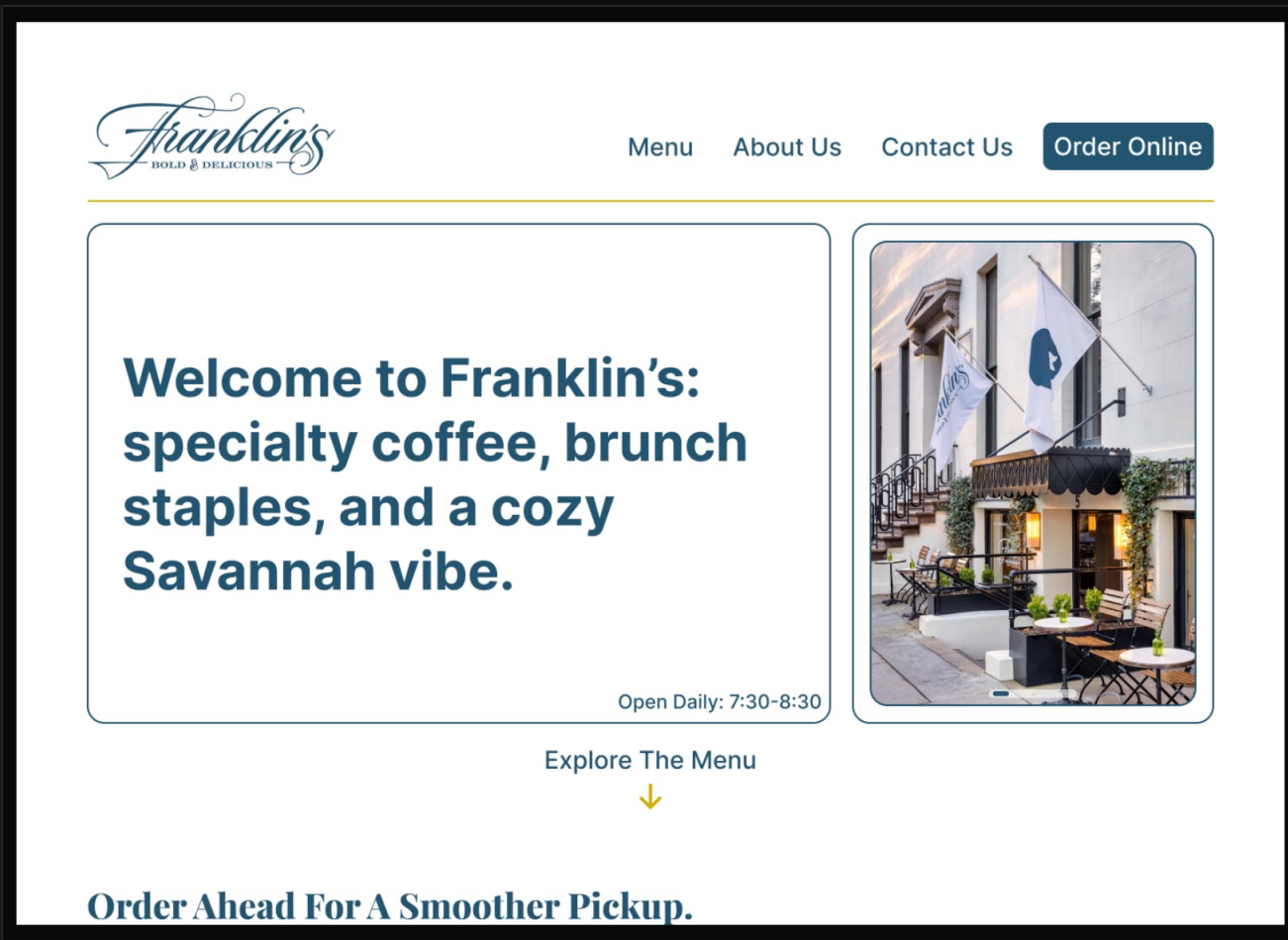
Card Sorting

- 1 We began by reviewing the existing information architecture to understand its structure and limitations.
- 2 Our goal was to see whether users naturally grouped content in the same way the IA suggested or if different patterns emerged.
- 3 Because the IA was relatively short, narrow, and predictable, we chose open card sorting to avoid influencing user decisions.
- 4 We created simple, neutral cards representing key pages and set up the activity in FigJam for easy grouping and renaming.
- 5 Participants were given minimal instructions and asked to organise the cards in a way that felt intuitive to them.
- 6 We analysed the results to identify recurring groupings and labels, using these insights to validate and refine the navigation and page hierarchy.



The redesign didn't change Franklin's identity — it made it clearer upfront.

Task-based navigation, a restructured homepage, a cleaner menu, and a step-by-step order flow from discovery to checkout.



OUTCOME_

The experience gap wasn't a design problem — it was an information problem.

LEADERSHIP_

The most important job of a team lead is keeping the work honest.

NEXT_

Explore in-context digital touchpoints at the storefront itself.